

Andrii Nikolaiev, PhD

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SUMMARY

Program Manager with 10+ years in EdTech, leading STEM initiatives, educational programmes, and startup operations; most recently managing frontier AI evaluation projects. Researcher with a PhD in CompSci and 5+ years of AI/ML/NLP experience.

EDUCATION

Visiting Research Student

NLIP Group, University of Cambridge (2023–2025)

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Taras Shevchenko National Univ. of Kyiv (2020–2025)

B.Sc. & M.Sc. in Computer Science

Taras Shevchenko National Univ. of Kyiv (2014–2020)

GRANTS & AWARDS

- Emergent Ventures Fellow, Mercatus Center, USA (2023–Present)
- Fully funded research fellowship, University of Cambridge, UK (2023–2025)

SKILLS

- Program Management:** Team leadership, quality control, stakeholder management, budgeting
- Entrepreneurship:** Company operations, business development, financial planning, contractor management
- LLM Evaluation & Research:** Benchmarking, LLM-as-a-Judge, prompt engineering, human evaluation, agentic AI
- Technical:** Python, SQL, PyTorch, Hugging Face, vLLM, GCP, Linux
- Tools:** Slack, Monday, Notion, Linear, Google Workspace, SurveyMonkey, Mailchimp
- Languages:** English, Ukrainian
- Interests:** Half-marathons (PB: 01:31:16), football, hiking, yoga

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Project Manager, Mercor

Feb 2026 – Present

- Designed pilot studies, evaluation rubrics and experiments assessing frontier AI models on economically meaningful tasks (*APEX-Agents, Terminal-Bench*).
- Analysed AI agentic behaviour – MCP tool usage, computer & browser user actions (CUA, BUA), reasoning, code execution.
- Oversaw teams of 700+ people across several project directions; collaborated with stakeholders and domain experts across industries.

Co-founder & CEO, Kvanta.STEM EdTech

2016 – Present

- Built a national year-round STEM programme with 1,000+ learners, 70+ instructors, and \$250K+ in secured funding, backed by *Emergent Ventures, XTX Markets, GlobalLogic, Admixer*.
- Designed Olympiad-level programs in mathematics, programming, and science; organised boot camps for up to 300+ participants (online & in-person).

Partnerships Project Manager, Roosh Investment Group

Sep 2021 – Mar 2022

- Managed institutional partnerships; handled communications with educational organisations and stakeholders.
- Planned and coordinated events for 200+ participants, overseeing scheduling and operational execution.

Program Manager, NGO Kontora Pi

Jan – Aug 2019

- Managed national educational programmes, including multi-day boot camps, for nurturing STEM talents; handled operational planning and budget execution.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Researcher in NLP, University of Cambridge

Apr 2023 – Present

- Developed novel symbolic benchmarks for combinatorial reasoning, revealing reasoning gaps across frontier LLMs.
- Deployed and evaluated open-source and proprietary LLMs on HPC clusters and cloud VMs.
- Assisted *Machine Learning for Real-world Data* seminars at the University.

Researcher in LLM Benchmarking, Osiris AI

Aug – Sep 2025

- Architected a distributed multimodal pipeline for OCR and segmentation of historical handwritten records via custom RAG methods.

Ph.D. in Computer Science, Taras Shevchenko National Univ.

2020 – 2025

- Conducted large-scale benchmarking and analysis of LLM reasoning using over 1M Chain-of-Thought examples.
- Implemented LLM-as-a-Judge frameworks, reducing evaluation costs while maintaining strong alignment with expert judgements.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Neural Network Methods for Selecting and Generating Synthetic Variations of Combinatorial Problems, *Cybernetics and Systems Analysis*, Springer Nature, 2025.
- Can Language Models Rival Mathematics Students? Evaluating Mathematical Reasoning through Textual Manipulation and Human Experiments, *ACL RR*, arXiv preprint, 2024.